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COURSE UNIT: CUU 1201

COURSE NAME: HEALTH AWARENESS AND LIFE SKILLS

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1.Explain the impact of not living a positive live for those infected by HIV and Aids.

Not living a positive life while infected with HIV/AIDS can have serious physical, emotional, and social consequences. Here's how it impacts different aspects of life:

a) Leads to increased risk of transmission.

After a patient has been tested and diagnosed with AIDS some become bitter and refuse to take ARV's while others decide to live in denial of the fact that they have the virus within their system. For both kinds, they continue living their lives normally and continue to engage with other people as usual without taking any precaution. As a result, some of these may transmit the virus to others through unsafe sex, their blood may come in to contact with people who have wounds thereby transmitting the virus and some even though it has a minimal chance of transmitting the virus engage in kissing and poor hygiene practices. As a result of all these they end up transmitting the virus to others. Some do it knowingly while others who are yet to diagnosed do it unknowingly.

There is need for the infected to be educated on the risk and danger they pose to those in their environment and to ensure that they take the medication to increase their chances of growing old with their family and loved ones.

b) Leads to emotional stress

This can be as a result of constant negativity attitude towards ones HIV status which often leads to people living with HIV/AIDS to have heightened levels of emotional issues including fear, guilt, abandonment, lack of worth and harassment. Therefore, a positive environment to those affected with the disease is necessary to ensure solid emotional support.

c) Leads to reduced life expectancy.

As a result of the individuals who decide to live in denial of the fact that they have the virus within them and refuse to take the necessary and much needed caution, they stand a higher chance of dying. They may die due to the many attacks on their immune system. Some might die due to a simple disease attacking their weakened immune system such as pneumonia while others die as a result of finding out they have the disease when they are in the last stage and not much can be done to help them. Either way, without living a positive life victims might die leaving behind a huge loss to their loved ones and also to the country. Some of the victims might be farmers, others doctors and others teachers among others.

d) Leads to a decline in physical health

Neglecting necessary care like antiretroviral drugs, a balanced diet, and exercise can impair immunity and increase susceptibility to infections, leading to opportunistic illnesses like pneumonia, TB, and cancer. HIV/AIDS develops more quickly without treatment, resulting in serious health issues and reduced life expectancy.

e) Leads to a decline in mental health

Pessimistic mental perspectives can lead to anxiety, depression and decreased self-esteem, affecting the immune system and treatment efficacy. Enhancing the quality of life for HIV/AIDS patients can be achieved through maintaining a positive outlook, seeking help, and following treatment.

f) Leads to Substance Use Disorders

As a result of a negative view towards ones HIV status people living with HIV/AIDS tend to turn to alcohol and substance abuse in order to cope with the stress and anxiety as a result it can lead to people infected with the disease to neglect taking the medicine as prescribed and use of such substances can lead to damage of the immune system and further increasing their chances to transmit the virus.

g) Leads to non-compliance to treatment

People living with HIV/AIDS who lack a positive mindset often refuse to take antiretroviral therapy (ART), thus negatively impacting their health.

h) Leads to social Isolation

People who have a negative view towards their HIV status (people who are HIV positive) tend to isolate themselves due to fear of others opinion, stigma, discrimination and rejection by others this can lead to depression which in turn further negatively impacts their health

i) Leads to increased class absenteeism

Students who have a negative attitude towards their HIV status tend to avoid school and miss class due to the fear of rejection, stigma and discrimination that is associated with thus negatively impacting their education therefore a positive mindset is crucial for the education of students who have the HIV virus

j) Negative socioeconomic impact

People living with the HIV virus that have a negative mindset often tend to avoid workplaces due to fear of workplace discrimination which negatively impacts their overall work performance and may further lead to disputes with their employers.

The necessity of a Positive Life

A positive lifestyle including regular medical checkups, adherence to treatment, mental wellness, and social support helps individuals live long, healthy, and fulfilling lives despite being HIV-positive. Taking care of oneself physically, mentally, and emotionally ensures a better quality of life and a hopeful future.

References

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